

purchase only luxury or premium brands—far higher than in any other metro. In contrast, consumers in Delhi, Kolkata, and Chennai tend to view premium purchases as occasional or situational. This makes Mumbai a premium accelerator market, while other metros function as premium incubation zones, where trust and timing matter more than brand name alone.

The survey shows clear regional differences in spending priorities. While West India moves faster towards experiences and premium purchases, consumers in the North and South

while Delhi consumers are more inclined to reassess their choices. Kolkata's Gen Z stands out for its openness to experimentation. About 38% are likely to switch brands, and fashion dominates spending, with 54% reporting it as their top category, reflecting a strong role of curiosity and cultural identity.

Chennai, meanwhile, depicts a distinct financial behaviour. Half of respondents say they borrow frequently or occasionally from family or friends for lifestyle spending, the highest incidence among the metros.

When choosing a job, Gen Z

across multiple formats like OTT platforms, cinema, YouTube, stand-up comedy shows, and live events. Mumbai presents a peculiar case. Despite being the centre of the Indian film industry, it has the lowest share of spending on cinema (24%) among metros. Instead, young consumers in Mumbai lean more towards stand-up comedy and live events, a preference that is also visible across the western region. In contrast, Gen Z in the eastern region allocates the highest spend to OTT platforms, while cinema sees stronger traction in northern and southern regions.

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tend to prioritise asset-building before indulgence. East India, meanwhile, places a strong emphasis on upward mobility, even if it means stretching finances. Notably, 84% of respondents nationwide expect their spending to rise over the next 12 months, largely driven by inflation.

Among the metros, Mumbai emerged as the most brand-secure market. An overwhelming 85% say product quality is their primary purchase driver, and just 12% are likely to switch brands—the lowest share across metros. Delhi tells a different story. About 44% are likely to switch brands, and value for money (20%) carries significantly more weight in purchase decisions. In effect, Mumbai tends to reward consistency and proven quality,

prefers a balance between long-term career progression and financial growth, while job security is a distant third across both metro and non-metro cities.

SOCIAL MEDIA

While Instagram dominates discovery across metros, conversion behaviour diverges sharply. In Mumbai, 89% of the respondents rarely buy after discovering products on social media, signalling a highly filtered consumer. In Kolkata and Chennai, however, there are much higher post-exposure purchases, indicating that content reach alone does not translate into commercial impact, and influencer return on investment differs sharply across cities.

When it comes to entertainment, Gen Z spreads its spending

Though e-commerce and quick commerce platforms have changed how the country purchases its daily essentials, Gen Zs in metros, except Mumbai, still prefer going to physical stores for their daily needs. Mumbai stands out sharply in quick-commerce adoption. As many as 83% prefer using quick-commerce apps for daily purchases, while the figure stays below 45% in other metros. Delhi youngsters rely on both quick commerce and physical stores, while Kolkata and Chennai prefer going to the market over delivery at home. Overall, the western region reports 71% preference for quick-commerce apps, compared to under 30% across the other three regions. **BT**

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